Plan 3 · Kashmir in Winter (my pick)

Snow you can count on in late December: Srinagar houseboat, Gulmarg Gondola, Drung frozen waterfall, Doodhpathri, Sonamarg, Pahalgam–Aru, Martand, plus the new train over the Chenab bridge. 24 Dec 2026 – 3 Jan 2027

Why Kashmir is my choice for Plan 3

- **Most reliable snow in North India for these dates.** 21 Dec starts Chillai Kalan, the 40 coldest days. Gulmarg/Apharwat almost always has snow by late December. Himachal and Uttarakhand snow at 2,000–2,700 m is hit-or-miss in some years.
- **The train now goes all the way.** Vande Bharat Jammu Tawi ↔ Srinagar (direct since 2 May 2026) crosses the Chenab bridge (world's highest railway arch bridge) and the Anji Khad cable-stayed bridge. You avoid the 8–10 h winter road via Banihal.
- **Sonamarg is now open in winter.** The Z-Morh tunnel (opened 13 Jan 2025) keeps it accessible year-round.
- **Winter is off-season.** Houseboats and hotels are cheaper than summer, except Gulmarg on NYE.

Route	Hyderabad → Delhi → (overnight) Jammu → Vande Bharat → Srinagar 4N (+day trips) → Pahalgam 1N → Srinagar 1N → Vande Bharat → Jammu → Delhi → Hyderabad
Snow chances	Very high: Gulmarg, Apharwat, Sonamarg, Aru, Doodhpathri. Medium–high: Srinagar city (a few snowfalls a winter; Dal edges freeze)
Crowd level	Medium at Gulmarg (high on 30 Dec–1 Jan). Low at Doodhpathri, Drung, Aru, Martand, old Srinagar
Difficulty	Easy. Cold is the challenge: −5 to −12 °C at night in Gulmarg/Pahalgam, −2 to −6 °C in Srinagar
Budget (per person, 4 people)	≈ ₹22.7k shoestring (SL, Phase-1 gondola) · ≈ ₹30.4k recommended (3A, both gondola phases) · ≈ ₹38k if you fly Srinagar → Hyderabad back

Status check (as of the latest reports found)

J&K reopened Gulmarg, Sonamarg and Pahalgam in June 2025, and Yusmarg and **Doodhpathri** on 16 Feb 2026 (42 sites open by then).

Baisaran (Pahalgam) reopening could not be confirmed. **Chandanwari** was listed closed by District Anantnag till 31 Dec 2026. **Gurez, Bangus, Sinthan Top** are snow-bound in winter, so they're left out.

Prepaid SIMs from outside J&K **do not work** there. Make sure at least 2 people in the group have postpaid connections.

Getting there and back

Hyderabad → Delhi: trains that work for 24 Dec (early morning first)

Train	Boards in Hyderabad	Reaches	Runs	Classes · approx fare / person	Use on 24 Dec?
12285 Secunderabad–Nizamuddin Duronto	Secunderabad **12:50**	H. Nizamuddin ~10:40 next day (~22 h)	**Sun & Thu**	AC only · 3A ≈ ₹3,000–3,700 (meals incl.)	**Yes, 24 Dec is a Thursday**
12723 Telangana SF Exp	Hyderabad Deccan (Nampally) **06:00** · Secunderabad 06:20/06:25	New Delhi ~07:40–08:00 next day (~25.5 h)	Daily	SL ≈ ₹800 · 3A ≈ ₹2,100 · 2A ≈ ₹3,000	**Yes, best early-morning train**
22691 Bengaluru–Nizamuddin Rajdhani	Secunderabad **07:00 arr / 07:10 dep** (10-min halt)	H. Nizamuddin ~05:30 next day (~22 h)	Daily	3A ≈ ₹3,300–4,100 · 2A ≈ ₹4,500–5,500 (flexi fare, meals incl.)	Yes. Fastest morning option
22705 Tirupati–Jammu Tawi Humsafar	Secunderabad ~08:40	Delhi Safdarjung, then Jammu Tawi	Weekly (sources say Tue from Tirupati, so Wed at SC)	3A ≈ ₹3,300–3,900 (to Jammu)	Probably 23 Dec, not 24th. Verify. Useful for Plan 3

12723 major halts, in order (check availability to each): Hyderabad Deccan → Secunderabad → Kazipet → Ramagundam → Mancherial → Sirpur Kagaznagar → Balharshah → Chandrapur → Sevagram → Nagpur → Itarsi → Bhopal → Jhansi → Gwalior → Agra Cantt → New Delhi (about 18 halts in total, ~1,680 km). Confirmed times: HYB 06:00, SC 06:20/06:25, Kazipet 08:03/08:05, Ramagundam 09:28/09:30. Read the other times off NTES or IRCTC on the day.

Waitlisted? Check every halt this way

Step 1. Direct pairs. On IRCTC (or ConfirmTkt / ixigo, same data), search 24 Dec for HYB→NDLS, SC→NDLS, SC→NZM, HYB→NZM in 3A and SL. Note the status for each train: AVAILABLE / RAC / WL number.

Step 2. Every halt (as you asked). If HYB/SC→Delhi shows WL, search the same train from **HYB** to each later halt: Agra Cantt, Gwalior, Jhansi, Bhopal, Itarsi, Nagpur. Seats are split into quotas by distance, so a shorter ticket (e.g. HYB→Agra) can be AVAILABLE while HYB→Delhi is WL. If Agra/Gwalior is available, book it, ride to Agra (about 4 h before Delhi), then take any Agra→Delhi train, Gatimaan/Vande Bharat or bus (2–3.5 h, ₹300–800).

Step 3. Book from the train's origin. For trains that start outside Hyderabad (22691 Rajdhani from Bengaluru, 22705 Humsafar from Tirupati), search **origin→Delhi** (SBC→NZM, TPTY→NZM/Jammu) and set **Boarding Point = Secunderabad**. You pay the full-route fare, but the origin's general quota is often open when the Secunderabad quota is full.

Step 4. Board further up the line. Check the same trains from Kazipet / Ramagundam (table above). You can book HYB→Delhi and board at SC, but you cannot board before the boarding station on your ticket.

Step 5. Split journey. HYB→Nagpur (many trains, short) + Nagpur→Delhi (30+ trains, incl. Rajdhanis from the south). Leave at least 2–3 h for the change.

Step 6. Tatkal on 23 Dec. AC Tatkal opens 10:00 AM, sleeper 11:00 AM. You need an Aadhaar-authenticated IRCTC account (OTP). Log in at 9:55 with saved passenger lists and UPI ready. Premium Tatkal costs more but is easier to get.

Delhi → Hyderabad: trains that get you home by 3 Jan

Train	Leaves	Reaches Hyderabad	Runs	Approx fare (3A)	Fits 'home by 3 Jan'?
12724 Telangana SF Exp	New Delhi **16:00**	Hyderabad Deccan ~17:10 next day	Daily	≈ ₹2,100 (SL ≈ ₹800)	**Leave 2 Jan → home 3 Jan evening**
22692 Nizamuddin–Bengaluru Rajdhani	H. Nizamuddin late evening (≈20:30–21:00, verify)	Secunderabad 17:10 arr / 17:25 dep next day	Daily	≈ ₹3,300–4,100	**Leave 2 Jan → home 3 Jan 17:10**
12286 Nizamuddin–Secunderabad Duronto	H. Nizamuddin 15:55	Secunderabad ~14:35 next day	Mon & Fri	≈ ₹3,000–3,700	Leave 1 Jan (Fri) → home 2 Jan
22706 Jammu Tawi–Tirupati Humsafar	Jammu Tawi 05:45	Secunderabad ~18:00 next day	Weekly (verify day)	≈ ₹3,300–3,900	Only Plan 3, and only if it runs 1 Jan

Delhi ↔ Jammu ↔ Srinagar

Leg	Option	Timing	Approx fare
Delhi → Jammu Tawi (25 Dec night)	Several overnight trains from New Delhi / Old Delhi (e.g. 12425 Jammu Rajdhani, 12445 Uttar Sampark Kranti, 14033 Jammu Mail)	Leave ~19:30–22:00, reach ~05:00–07:30	SL ≈ ₹450–550 · 3A ≈ ₹1,200–1,400 (Rajdhani ≈ ₹1,800–2,100)
Alt: Delhi → Katra	22439 Vande Bharat, New Delhi 06:00 → Katra 14:00 (not Tue)	8 h	CC ≈ ₹1,550–1,650
Jammu → Srinagar	**26401 Vande Bharat** Jammu 06:20 → Srinagar 11:10 · **26403** Jammu 13:20 → Srinagar 18:00	~4 h 50 m	CC ≈ ₹700–1,600 (fares vary between reports; check IRCTC)
Srinagar → Jammu	**26402 Vande Bharat** Srinagar 14:00 → Jammu 18:50	~4 h 50 m	Same
Jammu → Delhi (1 Jan night)	Overnight trains leave Jammu ~19:30–22:00	Reach Delhi ~05:00–08:00	SL ≈ ₹500 · 3A ≈ ₹1,300
Direct Jammu → Secunderabad	22706 Humsafar, Jammu 05:45 (weekly; one source says Fri)	~36 h	3A ≈ ₹3,300–3,900

Vande Bharat timings are from the May 2026 launch reports (Kashmir Life, NewsX, Inshorts). Book the Jammu–Srinagar leg the moment your Delhi–Jammu ticket is confirmed: the chair car fills fast in holiday weeks. Keep 2–3 h between connections because winter fog delays Delhi trains.

Flights from Hyderabad (to save 1–2 days)

Route (non-stop)	Airlines	Flight time	Typical Dec-Jan one-way fare*	Useful for
Hyderabad ↔ Delhi	IndiGo, Air India, Akasa, SpiceJet (many daily)	~2 h 10 m	₹6,000–9,000 (24 Dec / 2 Jan can touch ₹10–12k)	Plans 1, 2, 3, 5
Hyderabad ↔ Srinagar	IndiGo, Air India Express	~3 h	₹9,600–11,100 (peak days up to ~₹15,700)	Plan 3

*Snapshot ranges from MakeMyTrip, Goibibo, Skyscanner, HappyFares and ixigo pages seen in Nov 2026, not live quotes. IndiGo cabin bag: 7 kg; check-in 15 kg on most fares. Winter jackets count, so wear the heaviest layers on the plane. Book within the next 1–2 weeks: Christmas/New Year fares on these routes usually climb steadily.

Comfort option

Fly back Srinagar → Hyderabad (IndiGo direct, ~₹9,600–11,100; NYE week can reach ₹15k) on 2 Jan. You get the whole of 1 Jan in Srinagar and skip ~40 h of trains, for about ₹7–8.5k extra per person. Or fly both ways (≈ ₹20–24k for flights alone, which goes over budget).

Day-by-day itinerary

Day 1 · Thu 24 Dec · Hyderabad → Delhi

• **12:50 12285 Duronto** (Secunderabad, Thu) → Nizamuddin 10:40 on 25 Dec. Or 06:00 12723 Telangana Express → New Delhi 07:40.

Stay: Train | **Day spend (per person):** ₹300 food (Duronto includes meals)

Day 2 · Fri 25 Dec · Christmas in Delhi → night train to Jammu

• Leave bags at the station cloak room. Humayun's Tomb (near Nizamuddin), Sacred Heart Cathedral (Christmas), Connaught Place, India Gate.

• Night train to Jammu Tawi. Buy snacks; carry water.

Stay: Train | **Day spend (per person):** ₹700 food + ₹200 local

Day 3 · Sat 26 Dec · Jammu → Srinagar on the Vande Bharat · Dal Lake

• **06:20 Vande Bharat 26401** (or 13:20 26403). Sit on the left side for the Chenab bridge views. Tunnels include the 12.7 km T-50.

• Check in to a **houseboat on Nigeen / Dal** (quieter than Boulevard-facing boats). Ask for a bukhari/heater and electric blankets.

• Sunset **shikara ride** (1–2 h, ₹600–900 per boat per hour, fixed boards at ghats). Evening walk on the Boulevard / Polo View market.

Stay: Houseboat (₹2,000–3,500 per room with breakfast & dinner in winter) | **Day spend (per person):** ₹1,000 train + ₹200 shikara share + ₹500 food

Day 4 · Sun 27 Dec · Gulmarg + Drung frozen waterfall

• Pre-book the **Gulmarg Gondola** on the official J&K Cable Car Corporation portal a few days ahead (fake sites exist): Phase 1 Gulmarg→Kongdoori ≈ ₹810, Phase 2 Kongdoori→Apharwat (3,980 m) ≈ ₹1,010. The Kongdoori–Mary's Shoulder chairlift is a separate ≈ ₹300 ticket.

• Cab Srinagar ⇄ Gulmarg ≈ ₹2,600–3,000 for the day. Leave 07:30. At **Tangmarg**, rent a long coat + snow boots (₹300–500). Tourist vehicles may have to switch to local taxis/chains after heavy snow.

• **Drung waterfall** (offbeat, ~5 km detour from Tangmarg) usually freezes solid in Chillai Kalan.

• In Gulmarg: Apharwat snowfields, St Mary's Church, Maharani temple, sledge rides (negotiate the rate first), beginner ski lesson (gear ≈ ₹700/day + instructor).

Stay: Srinagar houseboat (or a night in Tangmarg if you want sunrise) | **Day spend (per person):** ₹700 cab share + ₹1,820 gondola + ₹400 rent + ₹600 food

Day 5 · Mon 28 Dec · Doodhpathri, the quiet snow meadow

• **Doodhpathri** (42 km, Budgam): open snow meadows, the Shaliganga stream, pine forests, very few tourists. Reopened Feb 2026.

• En route: **Charar-e-Sharif** shrine. If Doodhpathri is snow-bound, swap to **Yusmarg** (also reopened; road can close for days after snow, so ask in the morning).

• Evening: old-city food at Khayyam Chowk (kebabs, harissa in winter mornings, nadru monje).

Stay: Srinagar | **Day spend (per person):** ₹700 cab share + ₹700 food

Day 6 · Tue 29 Dec · Sonamarg + Kheer Bhawani

• **Sonamarg** (80 km): winter snowfields; Thajiwas glacier walk or sledge (pony/sledge unions have rate boards, so bargain). Year-round access thanks to the Z-Morh tunnel.

• Return via **Kheer Bhawani** temple (Tulmulla) and the Sindh river villages. Optional: **Naranag** 8th-century temples near Kangan, if the side road is clear.

Stay: Srinagar | **Day spend (per person):** ₹800 cab share + ₹500 activities + ₹600 food

Day 7 · Wed 30 Dec · Srinagar → Pahalgam via saffron & ruins

• **Pampore** (saffron town, kahwa tasting), **Awantipora** 9th-century temple ruins, **Martand Sun Temple** (offbeat, Mattan, Anantnag), cricket-bat workshops at Sangam/Bijbehara.

• Afternoon: **Betaab valley** by Pahalgam union taxi (union rates ≈ ₹2,000–3,000 for the circuit). Lidder river walk.

Stay: Pahalgam riverside hotel (₹1,500–2,500 per room in winter) | **Day spend (per person):** ₹1,625 two-day cab share + ₹600 food

Day 8 · Thu 31 Dec · Aru valley snow → back to Srinagar for NYE

• **Aru valley** (12 km): snowbound meadow village. The quietest snow you'll get on this trip.

• Baisaran / Chandanwari only if officially reopened by then (ask the union stand).

• Back to Srinagar (~2.5 h). NYE on the houseboat: kangri, kahwa, wazwan dinner (pre-order ₹600–1,200 pp).

Stay: Srinagar houseboat / hotel | **Day spend (per person):** ₹625 union taxi share + ₹1,000 food/NYE

Day 9 · Fri 1 Jan · Old Srinagar → Vande Bharat to Jammu → night train

• Dawn **floating vegetable market** on Dal (05:30–07:00, by shikara).

• **Shah-e-Hamdan (Khanqah-e-Moula)** papier-mâché interiors, **Jamia Masjid**, **Pari Mahal** (city view), Hazratbal; Shankaracharya hill if time allows. Buy dry fruits and kahwa near Lal Chowk.

• **14:00 Vande Bharat 26402** → Jammu 18:50 → overnight train to Delhi (~20:00–22:00 dep).

Stay: Train | **Day spend (per person):** ₹1,000 VB + ₹600 food

Day 10 · Sat 2 Jan · Delhi → Hyderabad

• Arrive Delhi early morning. **16:00 12724 Telangana Express** (or 22692 Rajdhani from Nizamuddin late evening).

Stay: Train | **Day spend (per person):** ₹600 food

Day 11 · Sun 3 Jan · Home

• Hyderabad ~17:10.

Offbeat vs main places in this plan

Place	Type	Why	Winter access
Dal / Nigeen lake, Boulevard	Main	Houseboats, shikara, floating market	Open
Gulmarg + Gondola to Apharwat	Main	Highest gondola in Asia; assured snow	Open (Phase 2 shuts in high wind)
Drung frozen waterfall	Offbeat	Ice formations in Chillai Kalan	Usually open from Tangmarg
Doodhpathri	Offbeat	Quiet snow meadows, no crowd	Reopened Feb 2026; snow can block
Yusmarg (backup)	Offbeat	Pine meadows	Reopened; road may shut for weeks after snow
Sonamarg, Thajiwas	Main	Snowfields and glacier	Year-round since Z-Morh tunnel (Jan 2025)
Kheer Bhawani, Naranag	Offbeat	Spring temple; 8th-c. temple ruins	Kheer Bhawani open; Naranag road weather-dependent
Pampore, Awantipora, Martand	Offbeat	Saffron, 9th-c. ruins, Sun temple	Open
Pahalgam, Betaab, Aru	Main + offbeat	Lidder valley in snow	Open; Chandanwari closed till 31 Dec; Baisaran unconfirmed
Old Srinagar (Khanqah, Jamia, Pari Mahal)	Main	Heritage + food	Open

Bike rentals

Srinagar has a few RE rental shops (≈ ₹1,200–2,000/day) but riding in Chillai Kalan means black ice on the Gulmarg, Sonamarg and Pahalgam roads and −5 °C wind. **Not recommended this season.** Shared cabs at ₹2,600–3,500 per day split 4 ways cost about the same as 2 bikes plus fuel.

Winter gear: what to buy, what to rent, and where

Budget for gear: if you own nothing warm, expect ₹4,000–6,500 one-time purchase (thermals, fleece, gloves, cap, socks, sunglasses) + ₹800–1,500 in rentals on the trip (jacket, suit, boots, spikes). The per-plan budgets include only the **rental** part; the purchases you keep are listed separately.

Item	Need	Buy (Decathlon Hyderabad / local)	Rent (where & rate)	Advice
Thermal inner set (top + bottom) ×2	Must	₹800–1,200 per set (local ₹400–600)	Not rented (hygiene)	Buy. Merino/poly, not cotton
Fleece / sweater (mid layer)	Must	₹600–1,200	—	Buy
Padded / down jacket (rated −5 to −10 °C)	Must	₹2,500–5,000	Indiahikes rentals ₹55–80/day (ships to you); trek operators ₹100/day; Manali / Gulmarg shops ₹150–300/day	Rent if you'll never use it again. 10 days ≈ ₹600–1,000
One-piece snow suit	At snow points	—	Solang/Palchan, Kufri, Gulmarg, Tsomgo ₹250–500/day (often with gumboots)	Rent on the spot only on snow days
Gumboots / snow boots	At snow points	—	₹100–200/day (Lachung ~₹100; bundled with suit at Solang ₹400–500)	Rent on the spot
Waterproof trekking shoes	Must (Plans 2, 4, 5)	₹2,000–3,500 (Decathlon MH100/MH500)	Trek operators ₹100–150/day	Buy if you'll trek again
Waterproof gloves + woollen inners	Must	₹300–900 + ₹150	—	Buy
Woollen cap / balaclava / neck gaiter	Must	₹200–400 each	—	Buy
Woollen socks (4 pairs)	Must	₹400–600	—	Buy
UV400 sunglasses	Must on snow	₹300–800	—	Snow glare causes snow-blindness
Microspikes + gaiters	Chopta, Hatu, Jalori, Gulmarg walks	₹1,200–1,800	Chopta/Sari/Sankri ₹150–250/day; gaiters ₹100/day	Rent

Rental points on this route

Point	What you can rent	Rate
Tangmarg (on the Gulmarg road)	Long coat, gumboots/snow boots, gloves	₹300–500 per set
Gulmarg ski shops (incl. govt shop)	Skis/boots/poles, ski jacket, trousers, goggles	≈ ₹700 + ₹300 + ₹200 + ₹100 per day
Sonamarg / Pahalgam stalls	Gumboots, coats, sledges	₹200–400
Srinagar markets (buy)	Pheran (₹800–1,500, warm souvenir), woollen socks, kangri	Buy

Budget (per person, 4 people)

Item (per person)	Shoestring	Recommended	Notes
Train Hyderabad → Delhi	₹800	₹2,100	SL vs 3A Telangana (Duronto 3A ≈ ₹3,300)
Train Delhi → Jammu (overnight)	₹500	₹1,300	SL vs 3A
Vande Bharat Jammu → Srinagar	₹1,000	₹1,000	CC; fare estimates vary
Vande Bharat Srinagar → Jammu	₹1,000	₹1,000	
Train Jammu → Delhi (overnight)	₹500	₹1,300	
Train Delhi → Hyderabad	₹800	₹2,100	
Cabs: Gulmarg, Doodhpathri, Sonamarg (shared)	₹2,200	₹2,200	≈ ₹8.8k ÷ 4
Cab Srinagar ⇄ Pahalgam 2 days + union taxi	₹2,250	₹2,250	≈ ₹9k ÷ 4
Shikara, autos, metro	₹600	₹600	
Gulmarg Gondola	₹810	₹1,820	Phase 1 only vs both phases
Stays: 5N Srinagar (houseboat/hotel) + 1N Pahalgam	₹5,400	₹7,200	2 per room; houseboats incl. breakfast + dinner
Food (beyond houseboat meals) incl. train food	₹5,000	₹5,500	
Gear rentals (Tangmarg etc.)	₹800	₹1,000	
Buffer	₹1,000	₹1,000	
TOTAL per person	**₹22,660**	**₹30,370**	**Fits ₹25–30k on trains. Flying back from Srinagar instead of the 2 return trains adds ≈ ₹7–8.5k.**

Bookings to do now

- Return chain first: Vande Bharat Srinagar→Jammu (1 Jan) + Jammu→Delhi overnight (1 Jan) + Delhi→Hyderabad (2 Jan). Or the Srinagar→Hyderabad flight for 2 Jan if you choose comfort.
- Onward: Duronto 12285 / Telangana 12723 (24 Dec) + Delhi→Jammu overnight (25 Dec) + Vande Bharat Jammu→Srinagar (26 Dec).
- Houseboat for 26–29 Dec and 31 Dec (book via JKTDC-registered owners, with reviews). Pahalgam hotel 30 Dec.
- Gondola tickets: book online ~1 week before (only on the official portal).

Carry list

- Original photo ID (Aadhaar/DL) + 2 photocopies + **4 passport photos** (Sikkim permits, J&K checks).
- Power bank (cold drains batteries 2× faster), offline Google Maps, cash ₹5–8k (ATMs fail in snow areas).
- Basic meds: Diamox (only after a doctor's advice) for Nathula / Chandrashila / Zuluk, paracetamol, ORS, cold & cough tabs, band-aids, Vaseline.
- Small daypack, reusable bottle, thermos (hot water in −5 °C mornings), quick-dry towel, plastic bags for wet gear.
- Prepaid SIMs from outside J&K do not work in Kashmir. Carry at least one **postpaid** connection (Plan 3).

Safety & buffers

- Snow and roads change by the hour. Check HP/J&K/Sikkim/Uttarakhand police traffic updates and ask your homestay every evening. National emergency: **112**. HP disaster helpline: **1077**.

- Do not ride rented two-wheelers on fresh snow or black ice (Solang–Atal Tunnel, Narkanda, Gulmarg road, Chopta). Taxis with snow chains are safer after snowfall.
- Book stays for 24 Dec–1 Jan **in advance** (NYE rates in Manali/Shimla/Gulmarg/Darjeeling go 2–3× normal). Prefer free-cancellation rates.
- Keep 3 Jan as a pure buffer: plan to start the last long leg (hills → Delhi/airport) by 1 Jan, because snow and NYE traffic delay buses 3–8 h.
- Carry ID at all times; there are frequent security checks. Follow local advisories and keep the J&K Tourism / police helplines handy.
- Power cuts are common in winter. Houseboats with generators and bukhari heaters are worth the extra ₹300–500.

Sources checked

Reddit could not be searched from this environment (blocked), so traveller reports came from Team-BHP, Tripoto, travel blogs and local news. Live seat availability and live fares could not be fetched (IRCTC needs login and captcha). Use the checklists above to verify.

— Vande Bharat Jammu–Srinagar launch, timings 26401/26402/26403: Kashmir Life, NewsX, Inshorts, newkerala (Apr–May 2026)
— Delhi–Katra Vande Bharat 22439: The Quint, Business Today, EaseMyTrip, FabHotels
— Z-Morh tunnel / Sonamarg winter access: Herald Goa, Daily Excelsior, The Tribune, Kashmir Life (Jan 2025)
— Reopening of 14 sites incl. Doodhpathri & Yusmarg (16–17 Feb 2026): ETV Bharat, Kashmir Reader, ThePrint, Business Today, India TV
— Chandanwari/Aru/Betaab status & Pahalgam union rates: zoutons Pahalgam guide 2026, vargiskhan.com rate lists, charzanholidays
— Gulmarg Gondola fares: zoutons Gulmarg guide 2026, travelcoffee.in, kashmirtourbazaar; ski rental rates: cliffhangersindia, theunstumbled, aajtak
— Kashmir winter access (Yusmarg/Gurez/Doodhpathri): vargiskhan.com winter guide, travelcoffee.in, charzanholidays
— HYD–SXR fares: Skyscanner, MakeMyTrip, HappyFares, Air India Express, Goibibo (Nov 2026)